MADHAN IRULANDI

Senior Release Train Engineer & Technical Program Manager | SAFe® SM & POPM | Microsoft Certified Trainer

Chennai, India (open to relocation worldwide) • irulandi.madhan@gmail.com • LinkedIn • madhanirulandi.com

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Delivery leader with 13 years across retail, insurance and healthcare for clients including Walmart, MetLife, Manulife, Allstate, Anthem and John Hancock, on systems serving 20M+ insurance policyholders. Govern releases for 30+ teams and 200+ people and turn around at-risk programs. Microsoft Certified Trainer since 2020: 3,000+ people trained, 75+ guest lectures.

- **Turnaround.** Restarted a multi-million-dollar John Hancock platform stalled two years by COVID, clearing 400+ backlog tickets in 9 months and taking all 5 modernization initiatives live across 20+ business divisions.
- **Predictability.** Averaged 95%+ ART predictability (business value delivered against plan) every PI since taking over the train in Sep 2025, with no committed work carried over.
- **AI delivery.** Steered a hybrid AI and RAG compliance engine to production, lowering false alarms in customer onboarding from 30% to 10–15%.
- **Teaching.** 3,000+ people trained since 2020, 75+ guest lectures and 1,000+ professionals mentored.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Release & Program Leadership: Release Train Engineering, PI Planning, ART Sync, Scrum-of-Scrums, AI-Native SAFe®, Program & Portfolio Governance, Release Management, executive status reporting

Scrum & Agile Facilitation: Sprint Planning, Backlog Refinement, Retrospectives, Kanban, Agile coaching, mentoring Scrum Masters, onshore/offshore teams

Delivery Management: Budget ownership & estimation (spend, duration, team size), Risk & Dependency Management, RAID logs, change management, Function Point capacity planning, DevOps & CI/CD

Technology: Generative AI & RAG, Azure AI, AKS, Apigee (JWT, OAuth 2.0), GitLab, Jenkins, OpenText xPression & Exstream, SS&C Chorus BPM (AWD)

Mainframe: z/OS, COBOL, JCL, DB2, CICS, VSAM, CA-7

Tools: Jira, Confluence, Azure DevOps, ServiceNow, MS Project, Power BI, Tableau, SQL, Miro, Visio

Domains: Insurance, Financial Services, Healthcare, Retail

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ATOS | Senior Release Train Engineer / Program Manager — Sep 2025 – Present

Client: **Global insurer** · *Core API, Customer Engagement & Compliance AI · Hybrid*

- Steered a hybrid AI and RAG compliance engine to production, lowering false alarms in customer onboarding from 30% to 10–15%.
- Averaged 95%+ ART predictability (business value delivered against business value planned each PI), with no committed work carried over.
- Maintain a High health rating across the products, with under 5% sprint variance.
- Reduced technical debt and strengthened platform security, moving 15 core services to AKS and 7 microservices to Gradle.
- Govern releases for 30+ teams and 200+ people across a three-product portfolio (Core API, Customer Engagement and Compliance AI), reporting progress, risks and roadmap decisions to executive leadership.
- Coach Scrum Masters across the train through end-of-sprint check-ins and regular sessions on SAFe updates.

ATOS | Technical Product Manager / Release Train Engineer — Sep 2022 – Aug 2025

Client: **John Hancock** · *AWD to SS&C Chorus BPM modernization · Boston (On-site)*

- Restarted a multi-million-dollar platform program stalled for two years by COVID, rebuilding the release process and clearing 400+ backlog tickets in 9 months.

- Brought effort estimates to within 10% of actual work in the first quarter by introducing structured capacity planning (Function Point analysis), trimming overtime and idle time.
- Ran a portfolio of 5 modernization initiatives across 20+ business divisions, taking every one live through coordinated upgrades.
- Delivered the AWD workflow platform's first upgrades since its 2019 release, finishing most of the work by Q2 2023, within a year of taking over.
- Moved all my teams off AWD's legacy EnCorr and Viewstation desktops onto SS&C Chorus BPM, its current generation, before handing over in Aug 2025.

ATOS | Senior Scrum Master / Agile Project Manager **Sep 2020 – Aug 2022**

Client: **Allstate** · *Customer communications platform · Hybrid*

- Reached 20M+ Allstate and 400K Encompass Insurance policyholders with customer communications by deploying 750+ document templates.
- Moved production deployments from monthly to near-weekly by clearing blockers as the main escalation point between engineering and client executives.
- Cut program cost 25% by streamlining the SDLC, without hiring.
- Raised team velocity 30% through hands-on Agile coaching.

SYNTEL | Scrum Master / Agile Delivery Lead **Jan 2020 – Aug 2020**

Client: **TruStage** · *xPression document project · Acquired by Atos*

- Stood up a new team and ramped it to full speed within two months, completing half of the work on the xPression project for TruStage (formerly CUNA Mutual Group) with a third of the existing vendor's headcount.
- Shipped every production release defect-free by building a layered automated test framework for regression, smoke and schema checks.
- Shortened project schedules 35% by mentoring on-site and offshore engineers and running sprint retrospectives.
- Owned 2,000+ document requests from design to go-live.

COGNIZANT | Technology Lead / Senior Analyst **Jul 2017 – Jan 2020**

Client: **MetLife** · *Publisher to xPression migration · Chennai*

- Led MetLife's move from a legacy publisher to OpenText xPression, migrating 4,500+ policy documents and freeing up 2,000 engineering hours a quarter.
- Ensured every migrated asset went live without a single defect by designing test cases with QA.
- Earned a Certificate of Excellence jointly from MetLife and Cognizant (May 2019) for the migration.
- Standardized 500+ document applications, shrinking annual remediation costs.

COGNIZANT | Systems Engineer / Application Analyst **Jul 2015 – Jun 2017**

Client: **Anthem Blue Cross Blue Shield (now Elevance Health)** · *Exstream & xPression template consolidation · Chennai*

- Consolidated legacy layouts into dynamic master templates with OpenText Exstream and xPression, saving $300K a year in operating costs.
- Decreased post-implementation defects 25% with automated pre-flight QA checklists and structured knowledge transfer.
- Contributed to $400K in added annual revenue by strengthening client retention.
- Sped up bug resolution 15% across a 60-developer cross-functional team.

COGNIZANT | Production Support Engineer / Systems Analyst Trainee **Jul 2014 – Jun 2015**

Client: **Walmart** · *Item File & Order Management System · Chennai*

- Resolved 50+ critical P1/P2 outages and 120 high-priority incidents, beating SLA targets through peak retail periods.
- Automated competitive ("Comp") reporting in the Order Management System, saving 25 hours of manual work a week (30% less effort).
- Replaced manual supplier inventory and sales reports (SVIST) with automated ones built with the DBA team, producing them 3× faster and cutting production maintenance costs 17% in five months.
- Accelerated Walmart Item File incident resolution 20% in six months, strengthening production stability and data consistency.

- Supported the mainframe Order Management System on z/OS, working in COBOL, JCL, DB2, CICS and VSAM, with batch jobs scheduled in CA-7.

DELL TECHNOLOGIES | Senior Customer Care Representative **Aug 2013 – May 2014**

Client: **Blue Cross Blue Shield, Humana, Aetna, Conifer Health Solutions** *· Payment recovery, denial management & claims reconciliation · Chennai · Promoted from Customer Care Representative, Jan 2014*

- Headed a 15-member team as acting Operations Project Lead, recovering more than $150K a quarter by settling high-value payment discrepancies.
- Added over $100K a month to collections by tightening denial management with Tableau and Salesforce tracking and root-cause procedures.
- Curbed overdue payments 20% and prevented 35+ disputed claims a month, holding reimbursement turnaround at 5 days across 180+ high-value claims.
- Cut call handling time 33% and lifted CSAT above 90% with a first-contact resolution framework and weekly QA audits, then handed the fixes to the permanent team as workflow playbooks.

WIZCRAFT INTERNATIONAL ENTERTAINMENT · ENCOMPASS EVENT GROUP | Event Coordinator & Client Relations Specialist **Jun 2009 – Oct 2013**

IPL, Formula 1, motorsport & live events · Freelance · Part-time during and after my BE

- Ran a 40-strong hospitality crew on peak IPL match days at Chepauk for Chennai Super Kings, cutting VIP guest complaints by nearly a third.
- Kept the IPL Season 5 opening ceremony, the 100 Years of Indian Cinema celebration and the Mirchi Music Awards South on schedule by coordinating artists, guests, stage crews and production through last-minute changes.
- Oversaw the media center, podium ceremonies and hospitality suites for the JK Tyre Volkswagen Polo R Cup 2012, and built the hospitality plan for the Renault Duster media launch, winning formal appreciation from the client.
- Drove citywide promotions in Chennai for India's first Formula 1 Grand Prix in 2011, and resolved vendor delays and scheduling clashes on Celebrity Cricket League match days.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified AI-Native SAFe® Scrum Master • Certified AI-Native SAFe® Product Owner / Product Manager • Microsoft Certified Trainer
- Microsoft Azure AI Engineer Associate • Microsoft Azure Administrator Associate • GitLab Certified CI/CD Associate
- GitLab Certified Git Associate • Certified Jenkins Engineer • PagerDuty Incident Management • 80+ in total

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Electrical & Electronics | **VELS University**, First Class **2009 – 2013**

TRAINING, RECOGNITION & COMMUNITY

- **Training:** Microsoft Certified Trainer every year since 2020, teaching SAFe® practice (SM & POPM; not official Scaled Agile courses), Scrum & Kanban, Azure AI-102, AZ-104, AZ-900/AI-900/DP-900 and AWS & Google Cloud fundamentals to corporate teams, graduates and colleges.
- **Client feedback:** “Overall, your professionalism, organizational skills, and commitment to agile excellence make a real difference to our delivery and team confidence.” (Client Project Manager, insurance client).
- **Awards:** Eviden Spot Award, Scrum Master / Release Manager (Apr 2024); Star Volunteer, Atos Prayas Foundation (Mar 2023); Atos Spot Recognition for Interviewing and for Cloud Training (Feb 2022); Certificate of Excellence, MetLife & Cognizant (May 2019).
- **Speaking:** 75+ guest lectures, including Azure AI at VIT Chennai and Jeppiaar Engineering College, a cloud workshop for 215 Atos graduates, and CSR cloud training with NIIT Foundation and EduBridge India.
- **Code for Boston:** Volunteer member on the non-technical side (Sep 2022 – Aug 2025), helping newcomers get set up on MAPLE, Urban League Heat Pump Accelerator, National Police Data Coalition and HEAT.